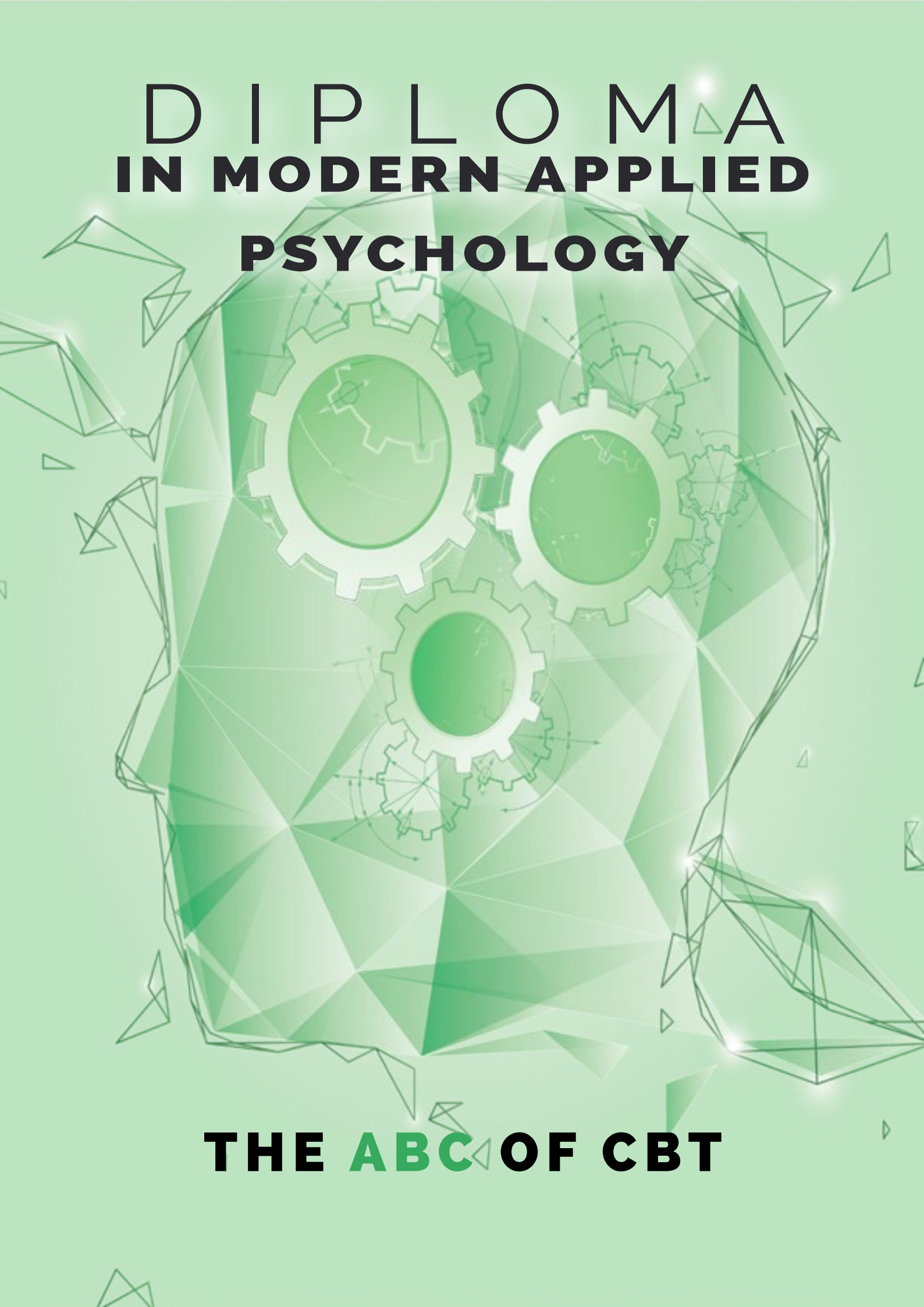


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background is a light green color with a complex, abstract geometric pattern. It features a large, faint silhouette of a human head in profile, facing right. Inside the head, there are three interlocking gears of different sizes, rendered in a slightly darker shade of green. The entire design is composed of various triangles and polygons, creating a low-poly or crystalline aesthetic. Some of these shapes have a slight glow or gradient effect.

THE ABC OF CBT

This model is a different way of looking at the Elisabeth Kubler Ross model.

Step One: Preconditions

People don't respond to reality: they respond to their perception of reality. However, their perceptions of reality are formulated from preconditions. These preconditions are our lifestyles and circumstances; the beliefs we've developed and adopted, the values we hold and our experiences (or lack thereof).

Step Two: Trigger

Triggers are activating life events (i.e. the things that happen to us). Triggers do not include our interpretations of events; they are merely the objective events themselves. We very rarely view triggers objectively because we become automatically consumed by our own experiences. When we lose our job, when we are broken up with, when our parents hurt us, when our friends ignore us, we are 'triggered'. Once we're triggered, we respond. If we fail to become responsible for our triggers (and expect the world to simply not trigger us), we will never become responsible for our own lives. Instead, we become dependent on other people tailoring to our emotional and perceptual needs and wants.

Our triggers are expressed automatically because they're learned behavioural responses to particular issues and events. Unless we make the conscious effort to unlearn our triggered behaviour, we will never stop being triggered by certain elements in life. We can't expect the world to bend to our needs and desires: we must learn to adjust and work through our issues in life.

Our perception database determines our triggers. Our perception database consists of our ideologies, subconscious mind, the stories we tell ourselves in relation to other people, the generalisations we've formulated and our past life experiences.

Step Three: State

Our interpretation of our triggers determines the state we fall into. Our state is our emotional, physical and behavioural response to external stimuli (i.e. triggers). The states we fall into produce both physical (i.e. our posture, our digestion, our body temperature etc) and cognitive changes (i.e. our beliefs, thoughts and emotions).

Step 4: Helpful Action or Unhelpful Action

Our approach to our state, regardless of whether the state is negative or positive, determines the ultimate outcome of our lives and future state. We're not always capable of managing our minds to fall into a positive state of being, but we do always have the strength and power to state positive action. It's acceptable and understandable to breakdown and cry for a while after going through a huge breakup, losing a family member or being fired from your job (not everyone can take those kinds of situations on the chin), but unless the emotions are used to inspire and motivate positive action and change, you allow yourself to become a victim of circumstance.

Step 5: Postcondition

Our postcondition is a more enhanced and validated perception database which is determined by the kind of action we took in stage four (i.e. our perception database either becomes more negative or more positive).

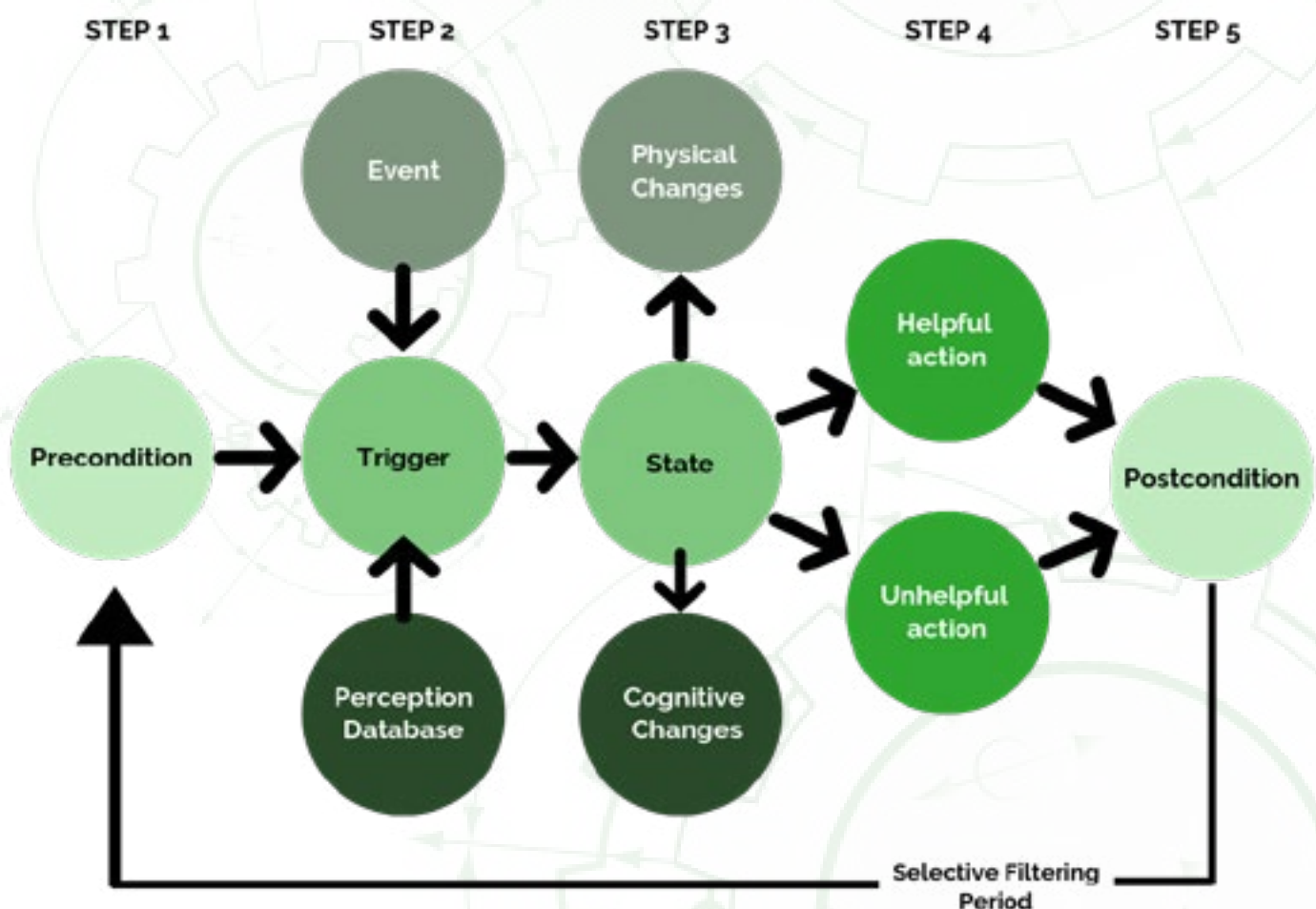


Exercise:

Study the diagram below and think about two events which have happened in your life: one which inspired positive action and another which inspired negative action.

Walking yourself through each of the stages, analyse how the event unfolded: what you believe your preconditions were, what triggered you, what state you fell into and what action you took. You will find space on the last two pages to full out and expand upon your experience.

This exercise will help you see understand how you respond to certain triggers and give you insight into what unhelpful patterns of behaviour and thought you fall into.



A time you took Unhelpful Action which produced a negative postcondition:

What event triggered this action?:

Can you identify the preconditions which caused you to be triggered by this event?

Can you theorise what your perception database was like at that time?

What physical, emotional and behavioural state did you enter because of your response to this event?

What cognitive changes took place?

What would have happened had you chosen to take helpful action because of this event?

How did the postcondition change your precondition today?



A time you took Helpful Action which produced a positive postcondition:

What event triggered this action?:

Can you identify the preconditions which caused you to be triggered by this event?

Can you theorise what your perception database was like at that time?

What physical, emotional and behavioural state did you enter because of your response to this event?

What cognitive changes took place?

What would have happened had you chosen to take unhelpful actions because of this event?

How did the postcondition change your precondition today?

